

Second Fermentation Flavor Chart

For 16 oz swing-top bottles. Print it and keep it where you brew.

Flavor · Bottle · Wait · Chill

For kombucha, water kefir
and homemade sodas

10–20%

FLAVORING

2–3 tbsp fruit or purée, or up to ¼ cup juice per 16 oz

~1 in

HEADSPACE

Less fizz with more; no room for pressure with less

2–4 days

ROOM TEMP

Out of direct sun. Warmer rooms go faster

Chill first

THEN OPEN

Several hours in the fridge before drinking

FLAVOR STARTING POINTS (PER 16 OZ BOTTLE)

FLAVOR	ADD TO THE BOTTLE	SPEED	CHECK AT
Ginger + lemon	1 tbsp grated fresh ginger + 1 tbsp lemon juice	FAST	Day 2
Mango	2 tbsp mango purée	FAST	Day 2
Pineapple	2–3 tbsp crushed pineapple, or ¼ cup pineapple juice	FAST	Day 2
Raspberry + mint	2–3 tbsp mashed raspberries + 2–3 mint leaves	TYPICAL	Day 2–3
Strawberry + basil	2–3 tbsp chopped strawberries + 1–2 basil leaves	TYPICAL	Day 2–3
Peach + vanilla	2–3 tbsp peach purée + ¼ tsp vanilla extract	TYPICAL	Day 2–3
Blueberry + lavender	2–3 tbsp mashed blueberries + a small pinch of dried culinary lavender	TYPICAL	Day 3
Apple + cinnamon	¼ cup apple juice + ½ cinnamon stick	TYPICAL	Day 3

Herbs and spices add flavor but almost no sugar, so pair them with fruit or juice for fizz. Warm kitchens run faster. Always chill and test one bottle first.

THE ROUTINE

- 1 Save your starter.** Set the SCOBY aside in about two cups of kombucha for the next batch.
- 2 Flavor the bottles.** Use the chart above, at 10–20% of the bottle.
- 3 Fill.** Stir, then funnel the kombucha in, leaving about an inch of headspace.
- 4 Seal and wait.** Clamp the tops shut. Room temperature, out of sun, for 2–4 days.
- 5 Test one.** After two days, chill one bottle and open it. Fizzy enough? Fridge the rest.
- 6 Refrigerate.** Cold slows fermentation and settles the carbonation in.

FLAT?

Tired gasket: the most common cause. Replace it.

Cool room: find a warmer spot or give it another day.

Too little sugar: add a bit more fruit or juice.

Too much headspace: fill to about an inch.

GUSHER-PROOF CHECKLIST

- ☐ Thick, **round** bottles made for carbonation, with no chips or cracks
- ☐ Gaskets soft and seated flat all the way around
- ☐ A reminder set for day 2. Forgotten bottles cause most gushers
- ☐ Fast fruits (mango, pineapple, ginger) checked early
- ☐ Unsure? Burp each bottle briefly once a day
- ☐ Bottles fermenting in a cabinet or cooler, not on an open shelf
- ☐ Chilled before opening, opened over the sink, hand on the cap

BATCH LOG

BOTTLED	FLAVOR & AMOUNT	DAYS OUT	FIZZ 1–5	NOTES

Safety: carbonation builds pressure. Use only bottles made for carbonated drinks, don't leave fermenting bottles unattended for long, and always chill before opening. Discard any batch with fuzzy mold.